

Design and Access Statement

Millbrook Solar & Storage – MDC/2026/0412

Liam McAllister · 16 June 2026 · MB-PLN-RPT-0004

1. Design principles

- Work with the existing field pattern: no field boundary is removed except 0.6 km of low-value hedge for access.
- Keep infrastructure low: trackers max. 2.9 m, inverter stations 2.6 m, only the substation reaches 6.5 m.
- Concentrate tall elements (BESS, substation) in the north-east, away from homes and the footpath.
- Design for reversibility: ground screws or driven piles, no concrete foundations under arrays.

2. Layout

IMAGE PLACEHOLDER

millbrook-site-aerial

High aerial view of eleven large arable fields with hedgerows, a narrow country lane along the southern edge and a small brook lined with willows on the western edge, late winter, overcast light.

The Site from the south-west (drone photo, March 2026)

The arrays are arranged in 22 blocks across ten fields. Rows run north–south so the trackers follow the sun from east to west. Internal tracks (4 m, permeable crushed stone) follow existing field gateways.

3. Appearance

Modules have an anti-reflective coating and dark frames. Inverter stations, the BESS containers and the substation control building will be finished in RAL 6007 bottle green. The perimeter is a 2 m wooden-post deer fence, not palisade fencing, except around the BESS and substation for safety reasons.

4. Access

During construction all HGVs use a temporary haul road from the B4127, removed after commissioning. Operational access (around 2 van visits per week) is from Mill Lane via the existing

Ashcombe Farm entrance. Footpath FP14 stays open throughout construction, with banksmen at the two crossing points of the internal track.

5. Landscape scheme

2.4 km of new species-rich native hedgerow (hawthorn, blackthorn, hazel, field maple, dog rose), hedgerow trees at 25 m spacing and 12.8 ha of wildflower margins along hedgerows and FP14. Existing hedgerows will be allowed to grow to at least 3 m.